

THE CREATOR NETWORK · AFFILIATE PLATFORM PLAYBOOK

Four platforms. Four jobs. One program.

TikTok Shop, Shopify Collabs, WHOP and Zion in one document — what each one is, how it is set up, what it costs, and which job it does that the others cannot. Read the comparison on the next page and the rest becomes obvious.

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VERSION

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PART 01

The four pathways compared.

	TIKTOK SHOP	SHOPIFY COLLABS	WHOP	ZION
What it is	Our storefront inside TikTok. Products listed, checkout in-app.	The affiliate layer on our own website.	A hub platform — courses, chat, leaderboards, campaigns.	The existing community Antoine runs.
Its one job	Turn scrolling into sales without a website visit.	Own the customer email and the subscription.	Affiliate infrastructure — education, competition, campaign briefs.	Community — events, hikes, meetups, our people's own events.
Where the sale happens	Inside TikTok	Our website	Nowhere — it points outward	Nowhere — it points outward
What we learn about the buyer	Very little. TikTok keeps the relationship.	Everything. Email, remarketing, subscription offer.	—	—
Affiliate commission	15% open · 20–25% targeted	10% / 15% / 20% by tier	n/a	n/a
Our cost	~6% referral fee + commission	2.9% on paid commissions	Free to run	Existing
Best for	Volume, discovery, Q4	Lifetime value, subscriptions	Making affiliates better at selling	Making people feel part of something

A creator can run all four at once and most should: TikTok Shop tags inside TikTok, the Collabs link and code everywhere else, WHOP for learning and competing, Zion for showing up. Attribution never crosses platforms — a sale lands in exactly one system, so there is nothing to reconcile.

THE ONE THING THAT DECIDES WHICH PATHWAY TO PUSH

A TikTok sale is a sale. A website sale is a sale **plus a customer** — the email, the permission to market again, and the subscription offer. When a creator asks which to prioritise, the honest answer is: use TikTok because that is where their audience already is, and use the link everywhere else because that is where our business compounds.

PART 02

TikTok Shop — setup and operation.

HOW IT FITS TOGETHER

TikTok Shop is the store. The TikTok Shop Affiliate Program is the creator side of that same store: a creator with 1,000+ followers adds our product to a video, the viewer buys without leaving the app, TikTok pays the creator the commission we set. We sit in the seller seat. Opening the shop is what makes the affiliate program possible — they are not two decisions.

- 01 Open the US Seller Center account.** Business email, EIN, W-9 info, ID, US bank account. Every name, address and tax detail must match exactly across documents — mismatches are the leading cause of delay.
- 02 Amechi delivers the product assets** — professional stills and video of every launch SKU, women-first casting, shot to the World Bible. Nothing lists without them.
- 03 List the launch catalog:** 8 oz coffee, chocolate, creatine packs. Food and beverage is a standard approval path.
- 04 Write listings in structure/function language** — "supports focus", "crafted for clarity". No treatment language, no before-and-afters.
- 05 Connect Shopify** via the official TikTok app so catalog, inventory and orders sync. Keep titles clean and attributes complete or listings break. Returns run through TikTok's portal.
- 06 Fulfillment: seller-fulfilled** to start. TikTok enforces dispatch SLAs and account health suffers when we miss them — shipping discipline is now a marketing function.
- 07 Turn on the affiliate program** — open collaboration at 15%, then the first targeted invite batch.
- 08 Verify the referral fee for our category** in Seller Center (roughly 6%; new sellers often get 3% for the first 30 days after the first sale).

LEVER	SETTING	WHY
Open collaboration	15%	Public rate any eligible creator can take. Puts us in the marketplace where creators browse for products.
Targeted collaboration	20–25%	Private invitations, 50 per batch, up to 1,000 a day. Where the real revenue lives — invited creators convert several times better.
Campaign windows	to 30%	Q4 pushes and drops. Rates lock 30 days per creator once they promote, so time changes carefully.
Free samples	~20/mo	Approved individually, 14-day posting window, \$300 budgeted at product cost.

WEIGHT EVERY INVITE BATCH TOWARD WOMEN

Marketplace search filters: US, 10k–200k followers, wellness / lifestyle / beauty / food, engagement over follower count. The audience directive is executed here more directly than anywhere else in the program — this is the single biggest lever on the 60/40 split.

THE Q4 CLOCK

WHEN	MOVE
Sept 15	Shop live, open collab on, first 50 invites, first samples
October	200 outreaches → ~20 active creators; LIVE tests; boost winners
Nov 1	Samples in creators' hands — the most time-sensitive date in the system
Nov 16–Dec 1	Wellness deal days Nov 22–24 ; BFCM push; bundles under \$30

Not on TikTok: the gummies. TikTok prohibits that category, so they sell through Shopify, Instagram, email and affiliate links. Settled — no further discussion needed this quarter.

Shopify Collabs — the website rail.

STEP ONE: CONFIRM IT EXISTS

Open Shopify admin → Apps. If Shopify Collabs is installed, screenshot it and proceed. **If it is not, install it that day** — it is free, it comes from Shopify, and every affiliate mechanic below depends on it. Do not spend a week deciding between apps; Collabs is sufficient and switching later is cheap.

CONFIGURATION

- 01 Audit the 23 existing affiliates.** Record codes, rates, sales to date. Migrate into tiers and **grandfather anyone already above their tier rate** — never cut a working affiliate's pay.
- 02 Verify attribution on every one of them.** Start with Ruben Torres, who is 42% of affiliate revenue and whose tracking still needs updating. Until this is done every number we report is understated.
- 03 Build one program per tier:** 10% / 15% / 20%, first order, new customers, taxes and shipping excluded.
- 04 Set the monthly tier review** for the first Monday, plus a mid-month check for anyone crossing a threshold.
- 05 Publish the application page** — and point the form at our own sheet as well, so we hold the data (Part 06).
- 06 Payouts:** 30-day hold matching the refund window, automatic payouts on, W-9 collection on.
- 07 UTM standard on every link:**
utm_source=collabs&utm_medium=affiliate&utm_campaign={creator} so GA4 shows which affiliates drive sessions, not just orders.
- 08 Codes:** one-word personal codes tied to the creator's name at 10% depth. Exclude already-discounted products from commission.

WHAT WE GET

- Unique link **and** unique code per affiliate, auto-generated.
- Product gifting from inventory, with tracking.
- Automatic payouts on the Shopify bill — twice monthly, \$25 minimum. Only real cost is 2.9% on paid commissions.
- Per-creator analytics: clicks, sales, commissions.
- **The gummies live here.** The full profit opportunity on the 20,000 units runs through this rail, Instagram and email.

KNOWN LIMITS, ACCEPTED

- Collabs paused new creator signups platform-wide, so its discovery network is frozen. Costs us nothing — our recruiting is outbound and through our own form.
- No native tiered commissions. We approximate with one program per tier and move people manually at review.
- Commission on first order. If lifetime recurring ever becomes the retention lever we need, that is the trigger to evaluate UpPromote or Refersion — not before.

ON DISCOUNT CODES APPEARING ON COUPON SITES

Mentioned in the Handbook as bad practice. **Not audited, not policed.** A code that is producing sales is producing sales, and the time it would take to chase leaks is better spent recruiting. Revisit only if a leak is visibly cannibalising margin at scale.

WHOP — the affiliate clubhouse, free until proven.

WHOP is where affiliates get better at selling. Creating a hub is free and WHOP only takes fees when money moves through it — so we build the whole thing, run it, and spend nothing until a capped test proves a paid campaign is worth it.

WHAT WE BUILD NOW, AT ZERO COST

APP	WHAT LIVES THERE

IF AND WHEN WE PAY — PROPOSED TEST ECONOMICS

Content Rewards pays creators per verified views from a budget deposited up front. Two ways to make it safe, and we should use both:

Course	The 20-minute orientation: products, story, approved language, the tier ladder, how payouts work, and the ManyChat walkthrough. Recorded once, works forever. This is the highest-value thing on the platform.
Chat	The daily room — announcements, wins, questions
Forum	Monday leaderboard, Thursday call recordings, campaign and challenge briefs
Events	Where affiliate meetings are hosted — the Thursday call runs here
Challenges	The monthly campaign brief with hashtag, deadline and prize (library in SM-AFF-10)

Everyone signs up. It takes two minutes and it is where the leaderboard and the education live.

Rate	\$3 per 5,000 views (= \$0.60 per 1,000)	Well below the \$1.50/1k in the earlier draft. Low enough to recruit a large volunteer army rather than a few expensive clippers.
Total budget	\$250, capped	A real test that cannot hurt us
Max per video	\$40	One viral clip can't drain it
Minimum payout	\$5 (≈8,300 views)	Low-effort clips never reach review
Approval	Manual, every submission	Never auto-approve

THE OPEN QUESTION, STATED PLAINLY

Paying per view is paying for attention rather than sales, which sits against the commission doctrine. The counter-argument is that a clipper army is top-of-funnel reach we cannot buy any other way, and at \$0.60 per thousand views it is cheaper than any ad platform. **The \$250 test is what settles it.** If cost-per-1,000-views comes in under \$1 blended and the clips are usable, scale it. If not, WHOP stays free forever and loses nothing.

Zion — the community side.

Zion already exists, Antoine already runs it, and event attendees already flow there. We are not building a second community — we are giving Supermind a proper presence inside the one we have.

WHAT SUPERMIND USES IT FOR

- **Hikes.** Posted, promoted, and photographed there. The hike community is the most on-brand audience we own.
- **Events we run** — Breakfast Club mornings, Black on the Block, drop nights.
- **Events our people run.** When an affiliate hosts something — a real-estate mastermind, a wellness workshop, a dinner — it gets promoted in Zion. This is the reciprocity that makes people stay: we don't just take their content, we fill their rooms.
- **Meetings and gatherings** that are community-facing rather than affiliate-operational.
- **Product feedback** before launches — reactions to the creatine and the collagen coffee before they roll out.

THE DIVISION OF LABOUR, SO NOTHING IS DUPLICATED

GOES IN WHOP	GOES IN ZION
Orientation course	Hikes and outdoor programming
Leaderboard and tier news	Events, ours and theirs
Thursday affiliate call	Community meetings and gatherings
Challenge and campaign briefs	Product feedback and previews
Payout and platform questions	The wider membership conversation

Everyone signs up to both. It is a two-minute cost to the affiliate and it keeps the affiliate machinery from cluttering the community — and the community from getting lost inside a sales program.

ANTOINE'S BRIEF

- Create the Supermind space and the events channel.
- Post every hike and every event with the membership framing consistent.
- Give affiliates a route to submit their own events for promotion.
- Notifications out ahead of anything the brand is running.

Instagram, ManyChat, and the application funnel.

THE GAP THIS CLOSSES

166,000 Instagram views and 615 profile taps in August produced **428 website sessions**. The audience is there. There is no bridge.

- 01 Amechi sets up ManyChat today** through his own account, which already runs the Keys and Supermind ManyChat. Cost is reimbursed with September expenses; credentials go on the shared password list the same day.
- 02 Build three flows first:** a keyword comment-to-DM that sends the shop link; an affiliate keyword that sends the application form; and a story-reply flow that answers the most common product question.
- 03 Every feed post gets a keyword** in the caption. No prices in the feed — the conversation moves to the DM and the DM does the converting.

THE APPLICATION FUNNEL — HOW IT IS BUILT

- 01 A branded application page** on the Supermind site (or a standalone page linked from bio and ManyChat). Fields: name, email, phone, Instagram / TikTok / YouTube handles with follower counts, niche, "why Supermind" in a paragraph, where they will promote, shipping address, and the two agreements — disclosure and the claims guidance.
- 02 Google Apps Script** posts every submission into a shared Google Sheet the whole team can see, timestamped, one row per applicant.
- 03 The sheet triggers the welcome email** automatically with their code, link, handbook and both community invites. Same script, or Shopify Collabs if it fires reliably.
- 04 Columns the team works from:** status, tier, code issued, welcome sent, community joined, first post, first sale, follow-up owner, notes.

04 Teach it to affiliates. The single highest-leverage technical upgrade we can hand them, and it is in the orientation course.

05 Celina works the sheet daily in the 10-minute check — approve, issue, message, log.

Amechi builds the page and the script; Celina owns the sheet and the follow-up. Full task breakdown in SM-AFF-08.

SOURCES

SUPERMIND Growth Initiative call, September 1, 2026 · TikTok Seller University — prohibited products, affiliate mechanics, holiday guide (seller-us.tiktok.com/university) · Shopify Help — Collabs manual, payouts, programs (help.shopify.com) · WHOP Docs — Content Rewards, courses, payout methods (docs.whop.com) · RYZE affiliate-to-partnership ladder (getsaral.com) · Fee analysis: fitsmallbusiness.com, getonecart.com · SM-AFF-00 Source of Truth.